

SOC INCIDENT TRIAGE REPORT

NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 2 Incident Handling Standard | Enterprise SOC Operations

Incident ID:	INC-2026-0813-SSH	Severity Level:	HIGH (Level 12)
Date / Time:	2026-08-17 22:42:40 PKT	Incident Status:	CONTAINED & CLOSED
Lead Analyst:	Muneeza Badar (SOC Tier 1)	Detection Source:	Wazuh SIEM
Category:	Credential Access (T1110)	Affected Asset:	Kali-linux

1. Executive Summary

On August 17, 2026, at 22:42:40 PKT, the Wazuh SIEM platform detected an automated Secure Shell Protocol (SSH) Brute-Force attack targeting host **Linux Host Kali Linux (192.168.1.10)**. The attack originated from external/attacker IP **192.168.1.6 (WINCLIENT-10)** using rapid authentication attempts to compromise local SSH account (Target user: DESKSTOP-D92D8FD).

The incident was captured via Linux authentication logs (`/var/log/auth.log`) and correlated using custom Wazuh Detection Rule ID: **100901 (Severity Level 12 – High)**. Rule 100901 correlated 3 failed SSH authentication attempts originating from the same source IP within a 120-second timeframe. Within 1.4 seconds of threshold violation, the SIEM identified the malicious velocity pattern.

Key Outcome: Upon rule correlation, the Wazuh Manager triggered the automated Active Response mechanism (firewall-drop). The wazuh-execd service on host kali-linux executed a dynamic iptables drop rule against attacker IP **192.168.1.6** for a duration of **300 seconds**, effectively dropping all incoming traffic and mitigating potential brute-force exploitation.

2. Incident Timeline

Timestamp (PKT)	Source / Entity	Event / Artifact	Action Taken
22:42:40.038	Kali Linux	sshd: Attempt to login using a non-existent user	Inbound SSH authentication probe on Port 22.
22:42:41.955	Wazuh Manager	Alert Rule 100901 Triggered	Threshold met (Velocity Brute-Force detected). Level 12 alert.
22:42:42.502 – 22:42:43.983	Kali Linux	Multiple Failed Login Attempts	Additional failed login attempts processed before block.
22:42:44.182	Wazuh Manager	Active Response Engine Triggered.	Host Blocked by firewall-drop Active Response.

3. Technical Investigation & Evidence Analysis

Analyzing kali-linux logs (An account failed to log on) in Wazuh Dashboard revealed key indicators of automated password guessing:

- **Target Account:** DESKSTOP-D92D8FD
- **Program name:** sshd-session
- **Source Port:** 56007
- **Source IP:** 192.168.1.6
- **Workstation Name:** WINCLIENT-10

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-08-17T17:42:41.955+0000",
  "rule": {
    "id": "100901", "level": 12,
    "description": "SSH Brute-Force Attack: Triggered 3 times from same IP within 2 Minutes"
  },
  "agent": {
    "id": "003", "name": "kali-linux", "ip": "192.168.1.10"
  },
  "data": {
    "srcip": "192.168.1.6", "srcuser": "armeen"
  },
  "full_log": "Aug 17 17:42:39 DESKSTOP-D92D8FD sshd-session[7938]: Invalid user armeen from 192.168.1.6 port 56007"
}
```

4. Containment, Eradication & Recovery

- 1. Containment:** Upon triggering Custom Rule 100901, Wazuh Active Response automatically applied a Active Response mechanism (Firewall-drop) to block all incoming traffic from attacker IP 192.168.1.6 for 5 minutes.
- 2. Eradication:** Active SSH sessions and authentication processes associated with attacker IP 192.168.1.6 were terminated automatically. Host-level access controls were re-verified, confirming no invalid target accounts were created or compromised.
- 3. Recovery:** After verifying host integrity and log continuity, normal SSH services were restored on kali-linux. The dynamic firewall block was set to automatically expire after a 300-second isolation window, maintaining baseline network availability while ensuring incident mitigation.

5. Lessons Learned & Recommendations

Finding	Root Cause	Remediation Plan
Exposed SSH Password Auth	SSH service permitted password-based logins without rate limiting or MFA.	Enforce SSH Key-Based Authentication (PubkeyAuthentication yes) and disable password authentication
Unrestricted Root / User Enumeration	Standard SSH port 22 exposed to local subnet allowing rapid user enumeration.	Restrict direct SSH access to authorized IPs via hosts.allow / firewall, and change the default SSH port.